

AffiliateAgent

The Complete Beginner's Guide

*Set up and run your AI-powered affiliate marketing
assistant in minutes - no coding required*

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Powered by Claude Agent SDK

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1. What is AffiliateAgent?

AffiliateAgent is an AI-powered assistant that helps you build and grow an affiliate marketing business. Instead of spending hours researching niches, hunting for affiliate programs, and writing product reviews, you give AffiliateAgent a simple command and it does the work for you.

What it can do for you:

- **Find profitable niches** - Discovers market opportunities with low competition and high earning potential
- **Discover affiliate programs** - Finds the best programs to join, compares commission rates and terms
- **Write SEO content** - Creates product reviews, comparisons, buying guides optimized for Google
- **Optimize for search engines** - Checks your content for SEO best practices automatically
- **Analyze performance** - Reviews your data and tells you exactly what to improve

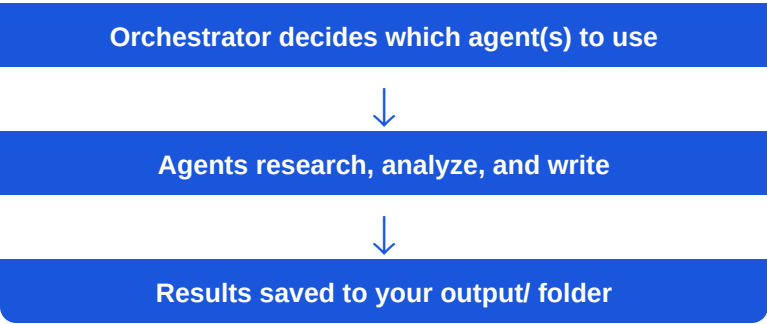
SUCCESS: You do NOT need to know how to code. This guide will walk you through every step with copy-paste commands. If you can type in a terminal, you can use AffiliateAgent.

How it works (simplified):

AffiliateAgent uses five specialized AI "agents" (think of them as virtual team members), each expert in a different area. When you give it a task, the main orchestrator figures out which agent(s) to use and coordinates their work. The agents search the web, analyze data, and write files - all automatically.

You type a command





2. What You Need Before Starting

Before running the setup, make sure you have these three things ready:

1 Python 3.10 or newer

Python is a programming language that AffiliateAgent runs on. Most modern Macs and Linux computers have it pre-installed. Windows users may need to install it.

Check by opening Terminal and typing: `python3 --version`

If you see 3.10 or higher, you're good! If not, download from python.org

2 Claude Code CLI

This is the engine that powers AffiliateAgent. It connects to Anthropic's AI.

Install it by running: `npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code`

Requires Node.js 18+. Get Node.js from nodejs.org if needed

3 Anthropic API Key

This is your personal key to access the AI. Think of it like a password for the AI service.

Get yours at: platform.claude.com

Sign up, go to API Keys, create a new key. Keep it secret!

TIP: Not sure if you have these? No worries! The Easy Installer in Chapter 3 will check for you and tell you exactly what's missing.

3. Step-by-Step Setup

We've created an Easy Installer script that does everything for you. Just follow these steps:

Step 1: Open your Terminal

On Mac: Press `Cmd + Space`, type "Terminal", press Enter

On Windows: Press `Win + R`, type "cmd", press Enter

On Linux: Press `Ctrl + Alt + T`

Step 2: Navigate to the project

Copy and paste this command, then press Enter:

```
cd ~/Desktop/affiliate-agent
```

NOTE: If you downloaded the project somewhere else, replace `~/Desktop/affiliate-agent` with your actual path.

Step 3: Run the Easy Installer

Copy and paste this command:

```
# On Mac/Linux:
chmod +x setup.sh && ./setup.sh

# On Windows (in Command Prompt):
python3 setup_windows.py
```

The installer will:

- ✓ Check that Python 3.10+ is installed
- ✓ Check that Claude Code CLI is available
- ✓ Create a virtual environment (keeps things tidy)
- ✓ Install all required packages
- ✓ Ask you for your Anthropic API key
- ✓ Create the output folder for your results

-
- ✓ Run a quick test to make sure everything works

Step 4: Verify the installation

After the installer finishes, test it:

```
source .venv/bin/activate  
affiliate-agent --version
```

You should see: `affiliate-agent, version 0.1.0`

WARNING: Every time you open a new terminal to use AffiliateAgent, first run: `source .venv/bin/activate` to activate the environment. The setup script will remind you of this.

4. Your First Command

Let's run your first task! We'll research a niche to see AffiliateAgent in action.

Try this command:

```
affiliate-agent research "portable blenders" --verbose
```

What happens next:

1. The AI searches the web for information about the portable blender market
2. It identifies the top keywords people search for (like "best portable blender")
3. It analyzes the competition (which sites rank for these keywords)
4. It finds affiliate programs (Amazon, BlendJet, etc.)
5. It scores the niche viability and writes recommendations
6. It saves a detailed report to `./output/niche-research-portable-blenders.md`

TIP: The `--verbose` flag shows you what the AI is doing in real time. Remove it for quieter output. Your first run may take 1-3 minutes depending on the complexity.

Reading the output:

Open the file `./output/niche-research-portable-blenders.md` with any text editor (TextEdit on Mac, Notepad on Windows). The `.md` file is Markdown format - it's plain text with simple formatting. You can also paste it into Google Docs or Notion for nicer formatting.

5. The 5 AI Agents Explained

Think of each agent as a specialist on your virtual marketing team. The main AI (the orchestrator) automatically picks the right agent for each job.

NicheScout

Market Researcher

Finds profitable niches by analyzing search trends, competition levels, keyword opportunities, and monetization potential.

Answers: ""Which niches can I actually compete in and make money?""

ProductFinder

Partnership Manager

Discovers affiliate programs, compares commission rates, cookie durations, payment terms, and product quality.

Answers: ""Which affiliate programs should I join in this niche?""

ContentCreator

Content Writer

Writes SEO-optimized product reviews, comparisons, buying guides, how-to articles, listicles, and roundups.

Answers: ""Write me a professional article that ranks on Google.""

SEOOptimizer

SEO Specialist

Analyzes content for keyword optimization, heading structure, meta tags, and search engine best practices.

Answers: ""Is my content optimized to rank well in search results?""

PerformanceAnalyst

Data Analyst

Reviews your affiliate data to calculate ROI, identify top performers, and provide optimization recommendations.

Answers: ""How are my campaigns performing and what should I improve?""

6. Complete Command Reference

research

Researches a niche for affiliate marketing viability.

```
affiliate-agent research "YOUR NICHE HERE"

# Examples:
affiliate-agent research "yoga mats"
affiliate-agent research "pet cameras" --verbose
affiliate-agent research "coffee grinders" -o ./reports --max-budget 2.0
```

find-products

Finds affiliate programs and products in a niche.

```
affiliate-agent find-products "YOUR NICHE HERE"

# Examples:
affiliate-agent find-products "gaming accessories"
affiliate-agent find-products "organic skincare" --verbose
```

create-content

Generates SEO-optimized articles. Requires --keyword (-k) flag.

```
affiliate-agent create-content "TOPIC" --type TYPE -k "KEYWORD"
```

```
# Content types: review, comparison, buying_guide,  
#               how_to, listicle, roundup
```

```
# Examples:
```

```
affiliate-agent create-content "Dyson V15" \  
  --type review -k "dyson v15 review"
```

```
affiliate-agent create-content "Robot Vacuums" \  
  --type buying_guide -k "best robot vacuum 2026"
```

```
affiliate-agent create-content "Roomba vs Roborock" \  
  --type comparison -k "roomba vs roborock"
```

analyze

Analyzes your affiliate performance data from a file.

```
affiliate-agent analyze YOUR_DATA_FILE.csv
```

```
# Examples:
```

```
affiliate-agent analyze ./data/march.csv -p "March 2026"
```

```
affiliate-agent analyze ./data/q1.json -p "Q1 2026" -v
```

chat

Interactive mode. Type any request and the AI handles it.

```
affiliate-agent chat
```

```
affiliate-agent chat --verbose --max-budget 5.0
```

Common Options (work with all commands):

Option	Short	What it does
--verbose	-v	Shows detailed AI output in real time
--output-dir	-o	Where to save results (default: ./output)
--model	-m	AI model to use (default: claude-sonnet-4-6)

--max-budget		Maximum \$ to spend on this command
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7. Real-World Workflow Examples

Here are complete workflows showing how to use AffiliateAgent for common affiliate marketing tasks.

Workflow A: Launch a New Niche Site

```
# Step 1: Research the niche
affiliate-agent research "standing desks" -v

# Step 2: Find the best affiliate programs
affiliate-agent find-products "standing desks" -v

# Step 3: Create a pillar buying guide
affiliate-agent create-content "Standing Desks" \
  --type buying_guide \
  -k "best standing desks 2026" -v

# Step 4: Write individual product reviews
affiliate-agent create-content "FlexiSpot E7" \
  --type review -k "flexispot e7 review" -v

# Step 5: Create a comparison article
affiliate-agent create-content "FlexiSpot vs Uplift" \
  --type comparison \
  -k "flexispot vs uplift desk" -v
```

Workflow B: Monthly Performance Review

```
# Analyze last month's data
affiliate-agent analyze ./data/feb-2026.csv \
  -p "February 2026" -v

# Then use chat mode for follow-up questions
affiliate-agent chat
> "My top article gets 5000 visits but only 0.3% conversion.
> What specific changes should I make?"
```

Workflow C: Quick Content Sprint

```
# Generate 3 articles in sequence
affiliate-agent create-content "Budget Headphones" \
  --type listicle -k "best budget headphones under 50" -v

affiliate-agent create-content "Noise Cancelling Guide" \
  --type how_to -k "how to choose noise cancelling headphones" -v

affiliate-agent create-content "Sony vs Bose" \
  --type comparison -k "sony wh1000xm6 vs bose qc ultra" -v
```

8. Understanding Your Output Files

All results are saved as .md (Markdown) files in the output/ folder. Here's how to find and use them:

File naming convention:

Command	Output file
research	output/niche-research-{niche}.md
find-products	output/products-{niche}.md
create-content (review)	output/review-{topic}.md
create-content (comparison)	output/comparison-{topic}.md
create-content (buying_guide)	output/buying_guide-{topic}.md
analyze	output/performance-report.md

How to open .md files:

- **Any text editor** - TextEdit (Mac), Notepad (Windows), or VS Code
- **Paste into Google Docs** - Copy the content, it'll look great
- **Paste into Notion** - Markdown is supported natively
- **Use a Markdown viewer** - Search for "Markdown preview" browser extension

9. Controlling Costs

AffiliateAgent uses the Anthropic API, which charges per use. Here's how to keep costs predictable:

Typical costs per task:

Task	Typical Cost	Suggested Budget Cap
Niche research	\$0.50 - \$2.00	\$3.00
Find products	\$0.30 - \$1.50	\$2.00
Create content	\$1.00 - \$3.00	\$5.00
Analyze performance	\$0.20 - \$0.80	\$1.50
Chat (per message)	\$0.10 - \$0.50	\$1.00

How to set a budget cap:

```
# Add --max-budget to any command
affiliate-agent research "yoga mats" --max-budget 2.0

# The agent will stop if it reaches $2.00
```

TIP: Start with small budgets (\$1-2) while you learn. You can always re-run a command with a higher budget if you need more detailed results.

10. Troubleshooting Common Issues

Problem: "command not found: affiliate-agent"

Why: You need to activate the virtual environment first.

Fix: `source .venv/bin/activate`

Problem: "API key not found"

Why: Your .env file is missing or the key isn't set.

Fix: Check that .env exists and contains: `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=sk-ant-...`

Problem: "ModuleNotFoundError"

Why: Dependencies aren't installed in the current environment.

Fix: `source .venv/bin/activate && pip install -e .`

Problem: Agent seems stuck or takes too long

Why: The AI may be doing extensive web research. Use `--max-budget` to set a limit.

Fix: `affiliate-agent research "niche" --max-budget 1.5`

Problem: "Permission denied" when running `setup.sh`

Why: The script needs execute permission.

Fix: `chmod +x setup.sh && ./setup.sh`

Problem: Output folder is empty

Why: The agent may have failed silently. Re-run with `--verbose` to see details.

Fix: `affiliate-agent research "niche" --verbose`

11. Glossary

Affiliate Marketing

Earning commissions by promoting other people's products. You share a special link, and when someone buys through it, you get paid.

API Key

A secret code that lets AffiliateAgent connect to the AI service. Like a password for the AI.

CLI

Command Line Interface. The text-based way to give commands to your computer (Terminal on Mac, Command Prompt on Windows).

Commission Rate

The percentage of a sale you earn. A 10% commission on a \$100 product = \$10 for you.

Cookie Duration

How long after someone clicks your link you still get credit for their purchase. 30 days means if they buy within 30 days, you get paid.

CPC

Cost Per Click. How much advertisers pay per click on ads for a keyword. Higher CPC = more commercial value.

CTR

Click-Through Rate. The percentage of people who click your affiliate link after seeing it.

EPC

Earnings Per Click. How much money you make on average for each click on your affiliate links.

FTC Disclosure

A required notice telling readers you earn commissions from links. Legally required in the US.

Keyword

A word or phrase people type into Google. "best wireless earbuds" is a keyword.

Markdown (.md)

A simple text format used for the output files. Readable as plain text, renders nicely with proper tools.

Niche

A specific topic or market segment. "Wireless earbuds" is a niche within "consumer electronics."

ROI

Return on Investment. If you spend \$100 and earn \$300, your ROI is 200%.

SEO

Search Engine Optimization. Making your content rank higher in Google search results.

Virtual Environment

An isolated space on your computer where AffiliateAgent's software lives, keeping it separate from other programs.

12. Quick Reference Card

Print this page and keep it near your computer!

Essential Commands

What you want to do	Command
Activate the environment	<code>source .venv/bin/activate</code>
Research a niche	<code>affiliate-agent research "NICHE"</code>
Find affiliate programs	<code>affiliate-agent find-products "NICHE"</code>
Write a product review	<code>affiliate-agent create-content "PRODUCT" --type review -k "KEYWORD"</code>
Write a comparison	<code>affiliate-agent create-content "A vs B" --type comparison -k "KEYWORD"</code>
Write a buying guide	<code>affiliate-agent create-content "CATEGORY" --type buying_guide -k "KEYWORD"</code>
Analyze performance	<code>affiliate-agent analyze DATA_FILE.csv</code>
Interactive chat	<code>affiliate-agent chat</code>
See verbose output	Add <code>--verbose</code> to any command
Set budget limit	Add <code>--max-budget 2.0</code> to any command

Content Types

Type	--type flag	Best for
Product Review	<code>review</code>	Single product deep-dive
Comparison	<code>comparison</code>	"X vs Y" articles
Buying Guide	<code>buying_guide</code>	"Best X for Y" roundups

How-To	how_to	Tutorials with product recs
Listicle	listicle	"Top 10" numbered lists
Roundup	roundup	Category winners overview

AffiliateAgent v0.1.0 | github.com/stay4ever/affiliate-agent | Powered by Claude Agent SDK